

Placement Matching and Admissions Policy

SECTIONS 1-4: PURPOSE, SCOPE, RESPONSIBILITIES & MATCHING PROCESS

1 PURPOSE

To ensure all placements are appropriate, safe and in the best interests of the child or young person in accordance with Tusla requirements, HIQA National Standards, Children First and Child Care Regulations.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All new admissions and placement decisions
- ✓ Matching process, risk assessment and consultation
- ✓ Involvement of the child, family and professionals
- ✓ Transition and compatibility checks

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Provider & PIC:** Final approval and oversight of matching
- ✓ **Admissions/Key Worker Team:** Gather information and complete assessments
- ✓ **Care Staff:** Prepare the house and young people for new arrivals
- ✓ **All Staff:** Contribute information and support successful integration
- ✓ **Registered Provider:** Ensure resources for appropriate placements

4 MATCHING PROCESS

- ✓ Comprehensive needs and risk assessment completed prior to placement
- ✓ Consultation with the child/young person and their views prioritised
- ✓ House compatibility and current resident group considered
- ✓ Detailed information shared with staff in advance
- ✓ Trial visits or introductory meetings arranged where possible

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SECTIONS 5-7: YOUNG PERSON INVOLVEMENT, TRANSITION & SUPPORT

5 YOUNG PERSON INVOLVEMENT

- ✓ To ensure the first, safeguarding must all children and young of children and young in development
- ✓ Child's wishes and feelings central to decision making
- ✓ Age-appropriate explanation of the placement process
- ✓ Welcome pack and orientation provided
- ✓ Opportunity to meet staff and other residents beforehand
- ✓ Feedback sought after placement and acted upon

6 TRANSITION SUPPORT

- ✓ Structured transition plan with key dates and support
- ✓ Key worker allocated immediately
- ✓ Emotional and practical support during move
- ✓ Liaison with previous placement and placing authority
- ✓ Risk and safety information fully shared

7 ONGOING REVIEW

- ✓ Placement suitability reviewed within first 4 weeks
- ✓ Adjustments made promptly if issues arise
- ✓ Multi-agency meeting held to monitor progress
- ✓ Family and social worker kept informed
- ✓ Positive experiences celebrated

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SECTIONS 8-10: COMPLIANCE, MONITORING & POLICY REVIEW

8 COMPLIANCE & RECORDING

- ✓ All decisions and assessments fully documented
- ✓ Legal and regulatory requirements strictly followed
- ✓ Staff training on placement matching provided
- ✓ Immediate escalation of any mismatch concerns
- ✓ Secure storage of sensitive placement information

9 MONITORING & REVIEW

- ✓ Audits of placement decisions and outcomes
- ✓ Feedback from young people, families and staff
- ✓ Analysis of placement stability and breakdowns
- ✓ Compliance with individual needs assessed
- ✓ Lessons learned shared with team

10 POLICY REVIEW

- ✓ Reviewed annually or sooner if required
- ✓ Incorporates audit findings, feedback and regulatory updates
- ✓ Considers trends in placement success and challenges
- ✓ Reviewed policy approved by Registered Provider and communicated to all staff
- ✓ Superseded versions archived per record management procedures